

Special report: El Niño's impact on global food commodities

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El Niño will concentrate food commodity inflation across vulnerable regions

A record El Niño is set to significantly drive up global food commodity prices. Latin America, the Asia-Pacific, and Africa face the sharpest production risks, with cocoa, robusta coffee, and wheat among the most exposed commodities to supply disruption.

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This report examines nine key commodities across Latin America, the Asia-Pacific, and Africa. It assesses how production disruptions driven by a record El Niño are being compounded by national policy risks, geopolitical dynamics, and conflict to create an interconnected set of risks for global food commodities.

Drawing on regional agricultural analysis and policy tracking, it evaluates how governments, markets, and supply chains are responding to mounting pressures, and where the most significant vulnerabilities remain.

Key takeaways:

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A record El Niño and disruptions to shipping in the Strait of Hormuz and Black Sea will drive global food commodity prices 10–18% higher by June 2027.

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Latin America, the Asia-Pacific, and Africa will be at the center of this price shock, given their geographic exposure to the weather pattern and their high export concentrations of commodities such as cocoa, robusta coffee, and wheat.

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Government measures—including strategic buffer stockpiling and the activation of drought preparedness programs—will cushion production declines, but policy risks remain elevated, particularly from government interventions on prices and exports.

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